



BACK TO BASICS

India's football dreams suffer from late starts, poor infrastructure, and fleeting plans. Can grassroots revival spark a **lasting change?**

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Indian football, once termed the 'sleeping giant of Asia', now basks in its reflected glory.

A FIFA ranking outside the top 120, no competitive wins in nearly two years, and a quagmire in the domestic setup — India languishes in one of the darkest chapters of its footballing history.

But is there a way out of the dungeon?
There are two ways to go about it from here — use

foreign imports of Indian descent for quick success, or strengthen the grassroots to create an assembly line for a better future.

While the former remains partially outside the All India Football Federation's (AIFF) purview — it would require a rule change by the Central Government — the latter has seen Asian countries like Uzbekistan and Japan reach the pinnacle of international football, the FIFA World